

Sins of the Land

Game Design Document (GDD) Prototype

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1 1. High Concept & Narrative Premise

Genre: Narrative RPG / Visual Novel

Engine: Unity

Target Audience: Players who enjoy story-driven deduction, atmospheric JRPGs, and deep, gradually unfolding lore.

1.1 Logline

Triggered by the tragic murder of a young girl, seven chosen souls must face a divine trial. The player navigates an island split between its corrupted modern reality and a pristine era 1500 years in the past. Guided by visions and haunted by a tyrant trapped in that ancient era, the player must uncover generational sins to survive.

1.2 Backstory & Lore Delivery

The narrative centers around a tyrant who lived 200 years ago and ruthlessly persecuted the islanders. Upon his death, divine punishment trapped his soul 1500 years in the past, during an era where the island was entirely devoid of human presence. Now, this desolate, ancient version of the island serves as a divine trial. The dark reality of the modern island's corruption is slowly unraveled by investigating the central mystery: the murder of a young girl.

2 2. Core Gameplay & Mechanics

2.1 The Deduction Loop

- **The Mind Map (Cognitive Device):** A glowing interface that automatically logs critical clues and character profiles encountered during the journey.
- **Synthesis (Person + Place + Object):** The player must open their inventory and deduce the correct collectible object that logically connects the current **Place** with the relevant **Person/Face**.
- **Temporal Shift:** Matching the correct triplet triggers a temporal transition, transporting the player 1500 years back in time to the human-free Ancient Island to experience a specific memory.

2.2 Stat Inheritance System (The 7 Souls)

The game features 7 playable characters, sequentially taking on the trial.

- **Dynamic Stats:** Each character has four core attributes: *Strength*, *Awareness*, *Anger*, and *Courage*. These stats directly unlock specific dialogue options and hidden locations.
- **Generational Legacy:** When a character's chapter concludes, their final stat values are inherited by the next playable character, making every dialogue choice and exploration action impactful for the long-term journey of the 7 souls.

3 3. Narrative Flow & Level Design

3.1 Opening Sequence & Tutorial

The game opens with a cinematic linear sequence managed by asynchronous scene loading. It begins with a metaphorical visual of a turbulent sea voyage. Upon taking control, the player

experiences a vision of their deceased sister, who introduces the glowing Mind Map mechanic. Following a symbolic funeral sequence, the player returns to their house, triggering the first temporal shift to the Ancient Island. Here, the sister says her final goodbye, and the player encounters the haunting whispers of the 200-year-old tyrant, officially starting the trial.

3.2 Environment & Atmosphere

The game features an isometric perspective with 2D visual assets. The environment actively shifts between two contrasting states:

- **Modern Island:** The present-day reality, bearing the weight of generations of hidden sins, societal corruption, and the protagonist's immediate grief over the murdered girl.
- **Ancient Island:** A pristine, untouched version of the island from 1500 years ago, devoid of humanity. It serves as the eternal prison for the tyrant's soul and the primary stage for the divine trial.

4 4. Technical Execution (Prototype Phase)

Developer Note: As a student transitioning into professional Unity development, I chose to build a clean architecture for the narrative flow rather than relying on standard nested coroutines.

- **Asynchronous Task Architecture:** The opening sequence and UI timing (such as subtitles and object flashing) are controlled via C# `async/await` methods. This allows for precise control over `Task.Delay` and scene transitions, keeping the codebase clean and highly readable.
- **Scene Management:** Visual transitions between the Modern and Ancient island states are handled through active/inactive toggles synchronized with the narrative triggers.